

Week 6.1

Grammar: be used to / get used to
Listening: for main ideas
Vocabulary: institutional traditions

Work in pairs. These people are wearing traditional dress from their countries. Guess which countries they are from.



Discuss the questions.

1. Describe traditional dress from Uzbekistan. Are there different costumes for different occasions? Do different regions have different costumes?
2. What other traditions (festivals, events, family traditions, etc) are there in Uzbekistan? Do you think they are relevant to the modern world? Explain why or why not.

Grammar: be used to / get used to

Listen to the conversation. What traditions are mentioned?



Listen to the conversation again. Write down every instance of *be / get used to* that you hear.



Complete the sentences with the correct form of be used to or get used to. Use negative forms where appropriate.

1. I can't _____ living here. The customs are just so different.
2. It's traditional to look after old people in my country, so people _____ it.
3. I _____ eating with chopsticks when I lived in Vietnam for a year.
4. If you _____ spicy food, you might find some of our dishes too hot!
5. Did you _____ speaking English all the time while you were there?
6. Don't worry about the local traditions – you _____ them in no time!

Work in pairs. Think of a time when you were in a new situation (e.g. a new school, a new neighbourhood, etc). Ask and answer the questions.

1. What things did you have to get used to in your new situation?
2. Are you completely used to them now?
3. Did it take you long to get used to them?
4. What helped you get used to them?
5. Was there anything you couldn't get used to?

Listening: for main ideas

Read the description in an online programme guide. Answer the questions on the right.

Monday, 2:00–2:30pm: Vox Pop

Interviewer Katie Miles hits the streets to ask people their opinions on the importance of traditions in society. Should we work hard to maintain our traditions, or should we allow them to change or disappear over time? Hear what people on the street have to say on the subject.

1. What specific traditions do you think people might mention? What vocabulary would you expect to hear related to those traditions?
2. What reasons might people give for maintaining traditions?
3. What reasons might they give for not maintaining traditions?

Listen to the interviews. Which interviewees think it's important for traditions to be maintained? Be prepared to justify your answers.

1. Interviewee 1

2. Interviewee 2

3. Interviewee 3

4. Interviewee 4



Listen again. Make a note of the reasons the interviewees give for their opinions.

1. Interviewee 1: _____
2. Interviewee 2 _____
3. Interviewee 3 _____
4. Interviewee 4 _____



Work in groups. Say which of the opinions expressed you agree with and why.

Vocabulary: institutional traditions

Look at the photo. What do you think it shows? How could it be connected to today's theme?



What traditions are described? What do you think the effect of these traditions is?

St. Andrews Tradition

St Andrews University has a number of traditions to get used to. There's Rory McLion, mascot of the University Charities Campaign, and there's the red academic gowns. And there's the PH. The letters appear in the pavement outside part of the university, and students avoid walking on them because anyone who does so is said to fail their degree! And then there's the academic family. One thing you'll need to do when you come to St Andrews is find yourself a mum and dad. You're going to need them for Raisin Weekend!

Raisin Weekend

Before you arrive at St Andrews, you need to arm yourself with knowledge of the traditions. One of the things you might have heard about is the academic family. This is a great way of forming relationships between students with different levels of experience. Higher-ranking students (mostly third- or fourth-year students) adopt freshers as their 'kids'. When you're adopted, your academic mother and father will help you during your time at university in all kinds of ways.

And you'll need your academic mother and father for Raisin Weekend, which is an initiation into the life of the university. On Raisin Sunday, your academic mother will invite you for a party in the morning, and your father will host a party in the evening. One part of the ritual is that you're expected to give your mother a present.

Welcome to St Andrews University!

Match the words (1–6) to the definitions (a–f).

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|------------------------|---|
| 1. initiation (n.) | a. first-year student at a university or college |
| 2. symbolic (adj.) | b. 1. a formal ceremony;
2. something that you do regularly and always in the same way |
| 3. high-ranking (adj.) | c. an animal, person or object used as a symbol of a team or organisation |
| 4. fresher (n.) | d. a process or ceremony in which someone becomes a member of a group |
| 5. ritual (n.) | e. in a position of importance in an organisation |
| 6. mascot (n.) | f. representing sth. important |

Work in groups. Discuss the questions.

1. Were there any rituals or traditions at your primary or secondary school?
2. Do you know of any rituals or traditions at IUT?
3. Why do you think some organisations have initiation rituals?
4. What examples of mascots can you think of? Do you know of any other mascot traditions?